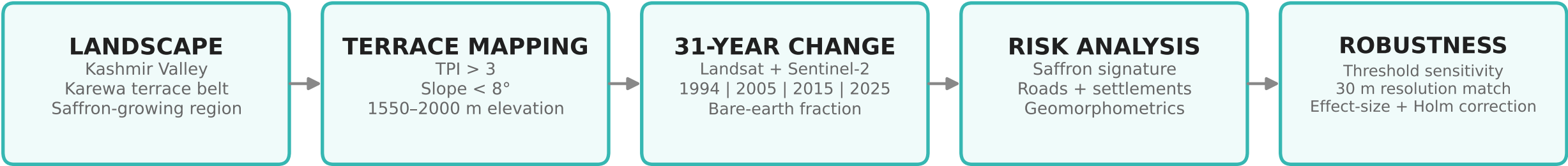


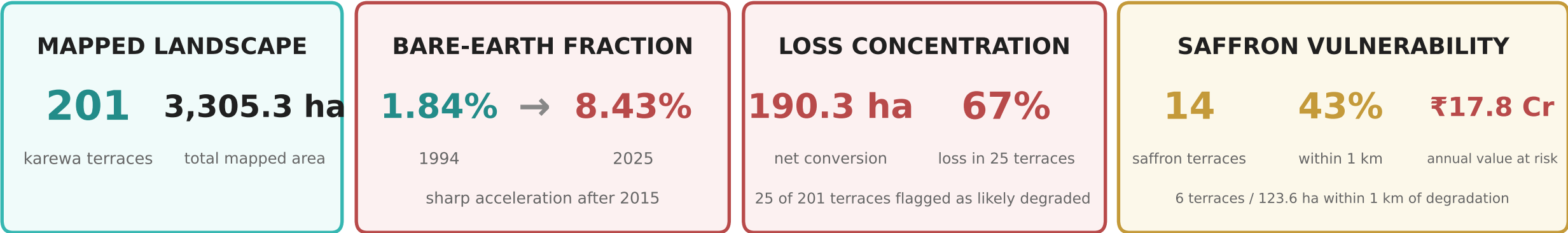
STOLEN STRATA: Quantifying the Anthropogenic Erasure of Kashmir's Karewa Terraces

and Its Threat to the Saffron Economy

Central Kashmir Valley | Multi-temporal remote sensing | 1994-2025



KEY RESULTS



SPATIAL + GEOMORPHOMETRIC EVIDENCE

ROADS	Degraded terraces closer to roads	p = 0.0116	SETTLEMENTS	Stronger proximity association	p = 0.0001
COMPACTNESS	0.138 degraded vs 0.191 intact	p = 0.0044	SLOPE	No significant difference	p = 0.1711

ROBUSTNESS • 2025 BEF: 8.43% → 7.48% at 30 m • Net conversion: 190.3 → 165.2 ha • Degraded terraces: 25 → 23

CONCLUSION Karewa degradation is recent, spatially concentrated, accessibility-associated, and economically relevant to saffron landscapes.